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Sound field control device and filter determination system

Abstract

Provided is a sound field control device including: a non-control-target component extractor configured to extract a non-control-target component from a sound source signal; a speaker selector configured to select one of plural speakers as a speaker to output the non-control-target component, based on the location of the listening area; a control-target component extractor configured to extract a control-target component from the sound source signal; a sound controller configured to, for each of the plural speakers, adjust the amplitude and the phase of the control-target component, based on locations of the listening area and a quiet area using filters each having coefficients set for the speaker; and sound combiners provided respectively for the plural speakers, the sound combiners each configured to combine the control-target component whose amplitude and phase have been adjusted and the non-control-target component and to output the combined result to the corresponding speaker.

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Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
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2008-252625	12/2007	JP	N/A

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) The present application claims the foreign priority benefit under Title 35 U.S.C. § 119 of Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-060443, filed on Mar. 31, 2022, in the Japan Patent Office, the disclosure of which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(2) The present invention relates to a sound field control device configured to produce a listening area and a quiet area in a sound field and to a filter determination system configured to determine filters to be used in the sound field control device.

2. Description of Related Art

(3) In recent years, efforts have been made to provide access to sustainable conveyance systems that consider vulnerable people such as elderly people and children among traffic participants. To achieve the aim, the efforts are focusing on research and development to further improve the safety and convenience of traffic through development related to improving the comfort of vehicles. Japanese Patent Publication No. 2004-147311 describes a parametric speaker which has high directionality by utilizing ultrasonic waves as a carrier of audible sound, as a technique for producing in a predetermined area a listening area where sound is audible and a quiet area where

the sound is inaudible to improve the comfort of the vehicle.

(4) Japanese Patent Publication No. 2008-252625 describes a directional speaker system including a primary sound source for producing a sound for listening and a secondary sound source for produce a sound for canceling the sound produced by the primary sound source.

(5) Regarding the improvement of comfort in the vehicle, it is difficult for the technique described in Japanese Patent Publication No. 2004-147311 to produce a wide listening area because the technique produces audible sound by interference of ultrasonic waves. In addition, the audible sound could reach the quiet area by reflection. The technique described in Japanese Patent Publication No. 2008-252625 requires an expensive processor be used because a large amount of computation is consumed due to the use of a finite impulse response (FIR) filter.

(6) The present invention has been made in view of the above-described circumstances, and it is an object of the present invention to provide a sound field control device capable of producing a listening area and a quiet area with a small amount of computation and thus reducing the cost, which contributes to evolving sustainable conveyance system and to provide a filter determination system that determines the filters to be used in the sound field control device.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) Provided by an embodiment according to the present invention is a sound field control device for producing a listening area and a quiet area in a sound field using a plurality of speakers, the sound field control device including: a non-control-target component extractor configured to extract a non-control-target component from a sound source signal; a speaker selector configured to select at least one of the plurality of speakers as a speaker to output the non-control-target component, based on a location of the listening area; at least one control-target component extractor each configured to extract a control-target component from the sound source signal; at least one sound controller provided respectively to the at least one control-target component extractor and configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers, adjust an amplitude and a phase of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor, based on locations of the listening area and the quiet area using a filter having coefficients set for the speaker; and a plurality of sound combiners provided respectively for the plurality of speakers, the sound combiners each configured to combine the control-target component which has been extracted by the at least one control-target component extractor and whose amplitude and phase have been adjusted and the non-control-target component to generate a combined result and to output the combined result to the corresponding speaker.

(8) Also provided by an embodiment according to the present invention is a filter determination system for setting the coefficients of the filters of the sound field control device, the filter determination system including: at least one microphone used to pick up sounds generated by the plurality of speakers, at a plurality of positions in the sound field; and a filter determination device configured to determine the coefficients of the filters based on the result of picking up the sounds by the at least one microphone so as to maximize a value obtained by dividing a value of sound energy in the listening area by a value of sound energy in the quiet area.

(9) According to the present invention, it is possible to produce a listening area and a quiet area with a small amount of computation and thus reduce the cost, which contributes to evolving sustainable conveyance system.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a vehicle to which a sound field control system and a filter determination system according to an embodiment of the invention have been applied.

(2) FIG. 2 is a schematic block diagram of the sound field control system according to the

embodiment of the invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic block diagram illustrating details of a listening/quiet area generator illustrated in FIG. 2.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of an example of a listening area and a quiet area produced by the sound field control system according to the embodiment of the invention.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of an example of a listening area and a quiet area produced by the sound field control system according to the embodiment of the invention.

(6) FIG. 6 is a schematic block diagram of the filter determination system according to the embodiment of the invention.

(7) FIG. 7 illustrates an example of a table that associates controlled frequencies with filter coefficients per listening area.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENT

(8) Subsequently, an embodiment of the invention is described in detail with reference to the drawings as appropriate. Note that in the drawings, “front” and “rear” respectively represents forward and rearward directions i.e., vehicle front-rear directions, of the vehicle; and “left” and “right” respectively represents left and right directions (vehicle width directions) as seen from the driver's seat.

(9) Sound Field Control System

(10) As illustrated in FIG. 1, a sound field control system 1A according to an embodiment of the present invention generates a sound field in the vehicle compartment of a vehicle C, which sound field is divided into a plurality of listening areas 2 (2-1 to 2-L, where L=4 in the embodiment) and a quiet area 3 (see FIG. 5) which is the counterpart of the listening areas 2

(11) Listening Area

(12) The listening areas 2 are areas for providing sound to occupants located in the listening areas 2. The listening areas 2 are set to locations corresponding to the seats (occupants) of the vehicle C. The listening area 2-1 is set at a position corresponding to the driver's seat of the front seats of the vehicle C. The listening area 2-2 is set at a position corresponding to the passenger seat of the front seats of the vehicle C. The listening area 2-3 is set at a position corresponding to the left seat of the rear seats of the vehicle C. The listening area 2-4 is set at a position corresponding to the right seat of the rear seats of the vehicle C.

(13) Quiet Area

(14) The quiet area 3 (see FIG. 5) is an area for not providing sound to occupant(s) located in the quiet area. The quiet area 3 is set in regions other than the listening areas 2 when the listening areas 2 are set in the vehicle compartment.

(15) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the sound field control system 1A includes a plurality of operation panels 4 (4-1 to 4-L, where L=4 in the embodiment), a plurality of sound sources 5 (5-1 to 5-L, where L=4 in the embodiment), a plurality of speakers 6 (6-1 to 6-M, where M=6 in the present embodiment), and a sound field control device 7.

(16) Operation Panel and Sound Source

(17) The operation panels 4 and the sound sources 5 are each provided for listening areas 2, respectively. The operation panels 4 each includes switch(s), button(s), and/or a touch panel, which are operable by the corresponding occupant of the vehicle C. The sound sources 5 each feed, for example, a sound signal (sound source signal) according to the result of an operation to the corresponding operation panel 4 to the sound field control device 7.

(18) Speaker

(19) At least one of the speakers 6 is provided for each of the listening areas 2. In the present embodiment, the speaker 6-1 is provided on a side of the driver's seat; the speaker 6-2 is provided on a side of the passenger seat; the speaker 6-3 is provided on the left side of the rear seats; the speaker 6-4 is provided on the right side of the rear seats; the speaker 6-5 is provided on a front part of the vehicle compartment; and the speaker 6-6 is provided on a dash board of a rear part the

vehicle compartment.

(20) Sound Field Control Device

(21) The sound field control device **7** generates sound signals for producing the listening areas **2** and the quiet area **3** (see FIG. **5**) based on the sound signals (sound source signals) fed from the sound sources **5** and feeds the generated sound signals to the speakers **6**. The sound field control device **7** is constructed of a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Read-Only Memory (ROM), a Random Access Memory (RAM), and an input-output circuitry. The sound field control device **7** includes, as functional blocks, a plurality of listening/quiet area generators **10** (**10-1** to **10-L**, where $L=4$ in this embodiment) and a plurality of sound combiners **20** (**20-1** to **20-M**, where $M=6$ in the present embodiment).

(22) Listening/Quiet Area Generator

(23) The listening/quiet area generators **10** correspond to the listening areas **2** respectively. In the present embodiment, the listening/quiet area generator **10-1** produces the listening area **2-1** and produces a quiet area **3** in the areas other than the listening area **2-1**; the listening/quiet area generator **10-2** produces the listening area **2-2** and produces a quiet area **3** in the areas other than the listening area **2-2**; the listening/quiet area generator **10-3** produces the listening area **2-3** and produces a quiet area **3** in the areas other than the listening area **2-3**; and the listening/quiet area generator **10-4** produces the listening area **2-4** and produces a quiet area **3** in the areas other than the listening area **2-4**.

(24) The listening/quiet area generators **10** each separates the sound signal fed from the corresponding sound source **5** into a non-control-target component and a control-target component, causes the speaker **6** near the corresponding listening area **2** to produce a sound of the non-control-target component, and adjusts the control-target component for each of the plurality of speakers **6** and causes the speaker **6** to produce a sound of the adjusted control-target component, thereby to generate the listening areas **2** and the quiet area **3**. Here, the non-control-target component means, of the sound signals fed from the corresponding sound source **5**, signals within a frequency band in which signals are attenuated according to the distance due to less influence of reflection owing to good sound absorption effect of the seats and interior members (signals in a relatively high frequency band, e.g., 500 Hz or higher). Here, the control-target component means, of the sound signals fed from the corresponding sound source **5**, signals within a frequency band in which signals are not attenuated (do not tend to be attenuated) according to the distance due to great influence of reflection owing to poor sound absorption effect of the seats and interior members (signals in a relatively low frequency band, e.g., less than 500 Hz). The listening/quiet area generators **10** each include, as functional blocks, a non-control-target component extractor **11**, a plurality of control-target component extractors **12** (**12-1** to **12-N**), a speaker selector **13**, a plurality of sound controllers **14** (**14-1** to **14-N**), a plurality of sound combiners **15** (**15-1** to **15-M**, where $M=6$ in the present embodiment).

(25) Non-Control-Target Component Extractor

(26) The non-control-target component extractor **11** is a bandpass filter that receives the sound signal fed from the corresponding sound source **5** and extracts a non-control-target component from the received sound signal. The passband of the bandpass filter is set for the frequency band of the non-control-target component (e.g., frequency band starting from 500 Hz or higher). The non-control-target component extractor **11** outputs the extracted non-control-target component to the speaker selector **13**.

(27) Control-Target Component Extractor

(28) The control-target component extractors **12** are provided respectively to frequency bands of the control-target components of the sound signal fed from the corresponding sound source **5**. Each of the control-target component extractors **12** receives the sound signal fed from the corresponding sound source **5** and extracts a control-target component (a component of a frequency band corresponding to the control-target component extractor **12**) from the received sound signal using a

Single-Frequency Adaptive Notch (SAN) filter. The SAN filter is a filter for adjusting the amplitude and phase of a periodic sound. The SAN filter is capable of generating a desired sound signal with a significantly less amount of computation compared to FIR filters. Each of the control-target component extractors **12** outputs the extracted control-target component to the corresponding sound controller **14**.

(29) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the control-target component extractor **12** separates a sound signal into two waveforms having different phases, amplifies them individually, and then combine the amplified waveforms, to extract a control-target component. The functional blocks of the control-target component extractor **12** include: a cosine wave generator **12a**, a sine wave generator **12b**, amplifiers **12c**, **12d**, a combiner **12e**, an inverter **12f**, a combiner **12g**, updaters **12h** and **12i**, amplifiers **12j** and **12k**, and a combiner **12m**.

(30) The cosine wave generator **12a** is a circuit configured to generate a cosine wave of the frequency band (angular frequency band $\omega=2\pi f$, where f denotes a frequency) corresponding to the control-target component extractor **12**. The cosine wave generator **12a** outputs the generated cosine wave ($\cos(\omega t)$) to the amplifier **12c**, updater **12h**, and amplifier **12j**.

(31) The sine wave generator **12b** is a circuit configured to generate a sine wave of the frequency band corresponding to the control-target component extractor **12**. The sine wave generator **12b** outputs the generated sine wave ($\sin(\omega t)$) to the amplifier **12d**, updater **12i**, and amplifier **12k**.

(32) The amplifier **12c** amplifies (adjusts the amplitude of) the cosine wave according to an SAN filter coefficient (A_c) set to the amplifier **12c** and outputs the amplification result ($A_c \times \cos(\omega t)$) to the combiner **12e**. The amplifier **12d** amplifies (adjusts the amplitude of) the sine wave according to an SAN filter coefficient (A_s) set to the amplifier **12d** and outputs the amplification result ($A_s \times \sin(\omega t)$) to the combiner **12e**. The combiner **12e** combines the amplified cosine wave and sine wave and output the combined result ($A_c \times \cos(\omega t) + A_s \times \sin(\omega t)$) to the inverter **12f** and to the sound controller **14**. The combined result of the combiner **12e** is a result of extracting from the sound signal S a cosine wave of the frequency band (angular frequency ω) corresponding to the control-target component extractor **12**. Note that the amplification of the cosine wave and sine wave by the amplifiers **12c** and **12d** includes such a case that the amplitude after amplification is less than the amplitude before amplification (the same applies to the other amplifiers).

(33) The inverter **12f** inverts the positive/negative (polarity) of the output from the combiner **12e** and outputs the inverted result ($-\{A_c \times \cos(\omega t) + A_s \times \sin(\omega t)\}$) to the combiner **12g**. The combiner **12g** combines the output from the inverter **12f** and the sound signal S fed from the sound source **5** and outputs the combined result ($S - \{A_c \times \cos(\omega t) + A_s \times \sin(\omega t)\}$) to the updaters **12h** and **12i**.

(34) The updaters **12h** and **12i** respectively update the coefficients A_c and A_s using a Least Mean Square (LMS) algorithm so that the output from the combiner **12g** (i.e., difference between the sound signal S from the sound source **5** and the output from the combiner **12e**) becomes zero. The updater **12h** updates the coefficient A_c based on the output from the cosine wave generator **12a** and the output from the combiner **12g** so that the output from the combiner **12g** becomes zero, and applies the result of the update to the amplifiers **12c** and **12k**. The updater **12i** updates the coefficient A_s based on the output from the sine wave generator **12b** and the output from the combiner **12g** so that the output from the combiner **12g** becomes zero, and applies the result of the update to the amplifiers **12d** and **12j**.

(35) The update operations on the coefficients A_c and A_s by the updaters **12h** and **12i** are represented by Equations (1), (2), and (3) below.

$$A_c(n+1) = A_c(n) + \mu \cdot \text{Math.e}(n) \cdot \text{Math.cos}(\omega n \Delta t) \quad (1)$$

$$A_s(n+1) = A_s(n) + \mu \cdot \text{Math.e}(n) \cdot \text{Math.sin}(\omega n \Delta t) \quad (2)$$

$$e(n) = s(n) - \{A_c(n) \cdot \text{Math.cos}(\omega n \Delta t) + A_s(n) \cdot \text{Math.sin}(\omega n \Delta t)\} \quad (3)$$

(36) Here, n represents a discrete time; Δt represents a sampling time period; and μ represents a step size parameter. The bandwidth of the control-target component to be extracted by the control-target component extractor **12** is controlled by the setting of the step size parameter μ .

(37) The amplifier **12j** amplifies (adjusts the amplitude of) the cosine wave according to the SAN filter coefficient (A_s) set to the amplifier **12j** and outputs the amplification result ($A_s \times \cos(\omega t)$) to the combiner **12m**. The amplifier **12k** amplifies (adjusts the amplitude of) the sine wave according to the SAN filter coefficient (A_c) set to the amplifier **12k** and outputs the amplification result ($A_c \times \sin(\omega t)$) to the combiner **12m**. The combiner **12m** combines the amplified cosine wave and sine wave and output the combined result ($A_s \times \cos(\omega t) + A_c \times \sin(\omega t)$) to the sound controller **14**. The combined result of the combiner **12m** is a result of extracting from the sound signal S a sine wave of the frequency band corresponding to the control-target component extractor **12**.

(38) Speaker Selector

(39) The speaker selector **13** receives the non-control-target component, selects at least one of the speakers **6** from which the received non-control-target component is to be outputted, and output the non-control-target component to the selected speaker **6** (in the present embodiment, to the sound combiner **20** corresponding to the selected speaker **6**). The speaker selector **13** may be configured to select the speaker **6** closest to the listening area **2** corresponding to the non-control-target component as the output destination.

(40) In the present embodiment, the speaker selector **13** of the listening/quiet area generator **10-1** selects the speaker **6-1** (sound combiner **20-1**) as the output destination of the non-control-target component originating from the sound source **5-1**; the speaker selector **13** of the listening/quiet area generator **10-2** selects the speaker **6-2** (sound combiner **20-2**) as the output destination of the non-control-target component originating from the sound source **5-2**; the speaker selector **13** of the listening/quiet area generator **10-3** selects the speaker **6-3** (sound combiner **20-3**) as the output destination of the non-control-target component originating from the sound source **5-3**; and the speaker selector **13** of the listening/quiet area generator **10-4** selects the speaker **6-4** (sound combiner **20-4**) as the output destination of the non-control-target component originating from the sound source **5-4**.

(41) Sound Controller

(42) The sound controller **14** receives the control-target components (combined results of the combiners **12e** and **12m**) and adjusts the amplitudes and phases of the received control-target components using SAN filters different from the control-target component extractor **12**. The sound controller **14** includes filters **14a** and **14b** and a combiner **14c** for each of the speakers **6**.

(43) The filter **14a** adjusts the combined result from the combiner **12e** according to an SAN filter coefficient W_r set to the filter **14a** and outputs the adjusted result ($W_r \{A_c \times \cos(\omega t) + A_s \times \sin(\omega t)\}$) to the combiner **14c**. The filter **14b** adjusts the combined result from the combiner **12e** according to an SAN filter coefficient W_i set to the filter **14b** and outputs the adjusted result ($W_i \{A_s \times \cos(\omega t) + A_c \times \sin(\omega t)\}$) to the combiner **14c**. The combiner **14c** combines the adjusted results of the filters **14a** and **14b** and outputs the combined result to the corresponding sound combiner **15**.

(44) The coefficients W_r , W_i are values to be multiplied to the amplitudes of the combined results. The coefficients W_r , W_i are set for the corresponding speaker **6**. For example, the filter **14a** corresponding to the m -th speaker **6- m** adjusts (the amplitude of) the combined result from the combiner **12e** using the coefficient W_{rm} ($m=1, \dots, M$, where $M=6$ in the present embodiment).

(45) Sound Combiner

(46) Each of the sound combiners **15** combines, for the corresponding speaker **6**, the sound signals of the frequency bands of the control-target components generated by the plurality of sound controllers **14** (and the non-control-target component as needed) and outputs the combined sound signal to the corresponding sound combiner **20**.

(47) Sound Combiner

(48) Each of the sound combiners **20** combines the sound signals each combined by the sound combiners **15** of each of the plurality of listening/quiet area generators **10** and outputs the combined sound signal to the corresponding speaker **6**.

(49) As illustrated in left part of FIG. 4, the sound field control device 7 may, in a state in which control is turned off, generate a sound that produces a listening area 2 (less densely hatched area) (see FIG. 5) in the entire space of the vehicle compartment. As shown in right part of FIG. 4, the sound field control device 7 may, in a state in which control is turned on, generate a sound that produces, in the vehicle compartment, a listening area 2 (less densely hatched area) in the vicinity of the driver's seat and a quiet area 3 (more densely hatched area)(see FIG. 5) in the vicinities of the other seats. In FIG. 4, the less densely hatched areas each represent an area where sound is audible (a high decibel area); and the more densely hatched areas each represent an area where sound is inaudible (a low decibel area).

(50) For example, as shown in FIG. 5, the listening/quiet area generator 10-1 corresponding to the listening area 2-1 may generate, as a result of the combining by the sound combiners 15, sound signals respectively for speakers 6 such that music is audible in the listening area 2-1 and the other areas are configured as a quiet area 3 in which the music is inaudible. In addition, the listening/quiet area generator 10-2 corresponding to the listening area 2-2 may generate, as a result of the combining by the sound combiners 15, sound signals respectively for speakers 6 such that news is audible in the listening area 2-2 and the other areas are configured as a quiet area 3 in which the news is inaudible. The sound field control device 7 generates, as a result of the combining by the sound combiners 20, sound signals respectively for speakers 6 such that the music is audible in the listening area 2-1, the news is audible in the listening area 2-2, and the other areas are configured as quiet area 3 in which the music and the news are inaudible.

(51) A sound field control device 7 according to the embodiment of the present invention is a device for producing a listening area 2 and a quiet area 3 using a plurality of speakers 6 in a sound field. The sound field control device 7 includes: a non-control-target component extractor 11 configured to extract a non-control-target component from a sound source signal; a speaker selector 13 configured to select at least one of the plurality of speakers 6 as a speaker to output the non-control-target component, based on the location of the listening area 2; at least one control-target component extractor 12 each configured to extract a control-target component from the sound source signal; at least one sound controller 14 provided respectively to the at least one control-target component extractor 12 and configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers 6, adjust an amplitude and a phase of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor 12, based on locations of the listening area 2 and the quiet area 3 using a filter having coefficients set for the speaker 6; a plurality of sound combiners 15 provided respectively for the plurality of speakers 6, the sound combiners 15 each configured to combine the control-target component which has been extracted by the at least one control-target component extractor 12 and whose amplitude and phase have been adjusted and the non-control-target component to generate a combined result and to output the combined result to the corresponding speaker 6.

(52) With this configuration, the sound field control device 7 causes the speaker 6 near the listening area 2 to generate a sound in the frequency band that is attenuated according to the distance, without adjusting the sound signal, which makes it possible to produce the listening area 2 and the quiet area 3 with a small amount of computation and thus lower the cost. When the sound field control device 7 is configured such that the non-control-target component extractor 11 and/or control-target component extractor 12 is configured to perform processing (extraction) using an SAN filter, the sound field control device 7 can produce the listening area 2 and the quiet area 3 with a small amount of computation compared to a case where an FIR filter is used, and thus the cost is lowered. That is, the sound field control device 7 contributes to evolving sustainable conveyance system.

(53) In the sound field control device 7, the at least one control-target component extractor 12 is a plurality of control-target component extractors 12 each configured to extract a control-target component having a frequency from the sound source signal; and the at least one sound controller

14 is a plurality of sound controllers **14** provided respectively to the plurality of control-target component extractors **12**. Each of the filters of each of the plurality of sound controllers **14** is an SAN filter set for the frequency of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor **12**. Each of the plurality of sound controllers **14** is further configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers **6** and for the frequency of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor **12**, adjust the amplitude and the phase of the control-target component using the corresponding SAN filter. Each of the plurality of sound combiners **15** is further configured to combine the control-target components whose amplitudes and phases have been adjusted for the respective speaker **6** and for each of the frequencies of the control-target components and the non-control-target component to generate the combined result.

(54) With this configuration, the sound field control device **7** performs control using an SAN filter for each frequency band, which makes it possible to produce the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** with a small amount of computation compared to a case in which an FIR filter is used and thus lower the cost and makes it possible to produce the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** in a suitable manner.

(55) Each of the at least one control-target component extractor **12** of the sound field control device **7** is configured to extract the control-target component using an SAN filter.

(56) Therefore, the sound field control device **7** performs control (extraction) using the SAN filter in the at least one control-target component extractor **12**, which makes it possible to produce the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** with a small amount of computation compared to a case where an FIR filter is used and thus lower the cost.

(57) Filter Determination System

(58) Subsequently, a description will be given of a system for determining the coefficients (W_{rm} , W_{im}) of the SAN filters for the sound controllers **14** of the sound field control device **7**. As illustrated in FIG. **6**, a filter determination system **1B** according to an embodiment of the present invention includes: a sound source **5**; a plurality of speakers **6** (**6-1** to **6-M**, where $M=6$ in the present embodiment); at least one microphone **8**; and a filter determination device **9**.

(59) Sound Source, Speaker, and Microphone

(60) In the present embodiment, the sound source **5** feeds a sound signal of the frequency band of each control-target component (control frequency) for which filter coefficients are to be determined to a corresponding one of the speakers **6**. The speakers **6** each generate a sound based on the sound signal fed from the sound source **5**. The at least one microphone **8** is used to pick up, at positions (grid points allocated in the form of a grid dividing the sound field) defined in the vehicle compartment (sound field) of the vehicle **C**, the sound of each control frequency generated by the speakers **6** and feeds the result of picking up the sound to the filter determination device **9**.

(61) The at least one microphone **8** may be configured such that at least one microphone is moved by an operator or a computer-controlled arm to each grid point to pick up the sound thereof. Alternatively, the at least one microphone **8** may be configured such that as many microphones as the number of the grid points are disposed at the grid points to pick up the sounds at the same time.

(62) Filter Determination Device

(63) The filter determination device **9** is constructed of a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Read-Only Memory (ROM), a Random Access Memory (RAM), an input-output circuitry, and the like. The filter determination device **9** determines the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}) of the filters (SAN filters) used in the sound controllers **14** of the sound field control device **7**, based on the result of picking up the sounds by the at least one microphone **8**.

(64) The filter determination device **9** controls the sound source **5** to cause each of the plurality of speakers to generate a sound for generating a sound field characteristic matrix G and, based on the result of picking up the sound by the microphone **8** arranged at each of the sound field grid points, generate the sound field characteristic matrix G , which contains sound field characteristics

G.sub.y,x of all the sound field grid points (see Equation (4) below).

$$(65) \quad G = \begin{bmatrix} G_{1,1} & \dots & G_{1,X} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ G_{Y,1} & \dots & G_{Y,X} \end{bmatrix} \quad (4)$$

(66) In Equation (4), Y corresponds to the number of the grid points and X corresponds to the number of the speakers **6** (X=M=6 in this embodiment).

(67) The sound field characteristics G.sub.y,x, which is the elements of the sound field characteristic matrix G, are each a transfer function of a sound generated by a speaker **6-x** to a microphone **8** located at a grid point y in the sound field. The filter determination device **9** calculates sound field characteristics (transfer function including a gain and a phase) G.sub.y,x based on the sounds to be generated by the speakers **6** and the sounds picked up by the microphone **8**.

(68) The filter determination device **9** generates matrices G.sub.V and G.sub.Q for the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** based on the sound field characteristic matrix G. The matrix G.sub.V relates to the sound field characteristic (transfer function) of one listening area **2**. The matrix G.sub.V contains, of the elements of the sound field characteristic matrix G, the sound field characteristics (transfer functions) of the grid points corresponding to the listening area **2** (in other words, contains zeros as the sound field characteristics of the grid points corresponding to the quiet area **3**). The matrix G.sub.Q relates to the sound field characteristic (transfer function) of a quiet area **3**, which is the counterpart of the one listening area **2**. The matrix G.sub.Q contains, of the elements of the sound field characteristic matrix G, the sound field characteristics (transfer functions) of the grid points corresponding to the quiet area **3** (in other words, contains zeros as the sound field characteristics of the grid points corresponding to the listening area **2**).

(69) The filter determination device **9** determines the coefficients W_r, W_i (W_{rm}, W_{im}) of the filters (SAN filters) used in the sound controllers **14** so as to maximize (sound energy in the listening area **2**)/(sound energy in the quiet area **3**). Here, the sound energy E.sub.V in the listening area **2** and the sound energy E.sub.Q in the quiet area **3** are respectively represented by Equations (5) and (6) below.

$$(70) \quad E_V \propto \sum_{u=1}^{YX} p_{Vu}^2 = W^H G_V^H G_V W \quad (5) \quad E_Q \propto \sum_{u=1}^{YX} p_{Qu}^2 = W^H G_Q^H G_Q W \quad (6)$$

(71) Here, p.sub.v,u represents the sound pressure at a grid point position u in the listening area **2**. p.sub.v,u represents the sound pressure at a grid point position u in the quiet area **3**.

(72) The filter determination device **9** calculates control characteristic W so as to maximize an evaluation function J=E.sub.V/E.sub.Q. The control characteristic W is an eigen vector corresponding to the maximum eigen values of the matrix

G.sub.H.sub.VG.sub.V[G.sub.H.sub.QG.sub.Q].sup.-1. The control characteristic W represent characteristics in the form of complex numbers and are given as Equation (7) below.

$$W = W_r + i \cdot W_i \quad (7)$$

(73) Specifically, the real parts W_r (W_{rm}) of the control characteristic W are the coefficients to be applied to the cosine wave components of the control-target components extracted by the control-target component extractors **12**; and the imaginary parts W_i (W_{im}) of the control characteristic W are the coefficients to be applied to the sine wave components of the control-target components extracted by the control-target component extractors **12**. The filter determination device **9** calculates such control characteristic W_r, W_i (W_{rm}, W_{im}) for each of the speakers **6**.

(74) The filter determination device **9** determines, for a listening area **2** (and the quiet area **3** which is the counterpart of the listening area **2**), the coefficients W_r, W_i (W_{rm}, W_{im}) for each frequency f (angular frequency ω). The filter determination device **9** determines such combination of the coefficients W_r, W_i (W_{rm}, W_{im}) for each listening area **2** (see FIG. 7). The filter determination

device **9** generates, for each listening area **2**, a table that associates the frequencies f and the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}), and store the table in a memory. Note that the values of the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}) are not limited to those specified in the table illustrated in FIG. 7.

(75) Each of the sound controllers **14** of the sound field control device **7** adjusts the control-target component using the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}) for the corresponding listening area **2** and the corresponding frequency f (angular frequency ω). Note that the sound controllers **14** may be configured to use the table generated by the filter determination device **9** in such a way as to store the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}) for each frequency f (angular frequency ω) for each listening area **2** per the listening area **2** in the form of a table and retrieve and use the coefficients W_r , W_i (W_{rm} , W_{im}) for a listening area **2**. In this case, it is possible for one combination of a control-target component extractor **12** and a sound controller **14** to process a plurality of listening areas **2**.

(76) A filter determination system **1B** according to an embodiment of the present invention is a system for setting the coefficients of the filters of the sound field control device **7**. The filter determination system **1B** includes: at least one microphone **8** used to pick up sounds generated by the plurality of speakers **6**, at a plurality of positions in the sound field; and a filter determination device **9** configured to determine the coefficients of the filters based on the result of picking up the sounds by the at least one microphone **8** so as to, regarding the listening area **2** set in the sound field and the quiet area **3** set in the sound field, maximize a value obtained by dividing a value of sound energy in the listening area **2** by a value of sound energy in the quiet area **3**.

(77) With this configuration, the filter determination system **1B** determines suitable filter coefficients for generating the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** in the sound field.

(78) The filter determination device **9** of the filter determination system **1B** determines, for each of the frequencies of the control-target components, the coefficients of the filters each functioning as an SAN filter so as to maximize a value obtained by dividing a value of sound energy in the listening area **2** by a value of sound energy in the quiet area **3**.

(79) With this configuration, the filter determination system **1B** determines suitable coefficients for the filter for producing the listening area **2** and the quiet area **3** in the sound field for each frequency band.

(80) The filter determination device **9** of the filter determination system **1B** generates a table in which the frequencies of the control-target components are associated with the coefficients.

(81) The filter determination system **1B** provides filter coefficients in a form suitable to the sound field control device **7**.

(82) Although an embodiment of the present invention has been described above, it is to be understood that the present invention is not limited only to the above-described embodiment and the embodiment can be modified as appropriate within the range not departing from the gist of the invention.

Claims

1. A sound field control device for producing a listening area and a quiet area in a sound field using a plurality of speakers, the sound field control device configured with a processor configured to function as: a non-control-target component extractor configured to extract a non-control-target component from a sound source signal; a speaker selector configured to select at least one of the plurality of speakers as a speaker to output the non-control-target component, based on a location of the listening area; at least one control-target component extractor each configured to extract a control-target component from the sound source signal; at least one sound controller provided respectively to the at least one control-target component extractor and configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers, adjust an amplitude and a phase of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor, based on locations of the listening area and the quiet area using a filter having coefficients set for the speaker; and a plurality of sound

combiners provided respectively for the plurality of speakers, the sound combiners each configured to combine the control-target component which has been extracted by the at least one control-target component extractor and whose amplitude and phase have been adjusted and the non-control-target component to generate a combined result and to output the combined result to the corresponding speaker, wherein the at least one control-target component extractor is a plurality of control-target component extractors each configured to extract a control-target component having a frequency from the sound source signal, wherein the at least one sound controller is a plurality of sound controllers provided respectively to the plurality of control-target component extractors, wherein each of the filters of each of the plurality of sound controllers is a single-frequency adaptive notch (SAN) filter set for the frequency of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor, wherein each of the plurality of sound controllers is further configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers and for the frequency of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor, adjust the amplitude and the phase of the control-target component using the corresponding SAN filter, and wherein each of the plurality of sound combiners is further configured to combine the control-target components whose amplitudes and phases have been adjusted for the respective speaker and for each of the frequencies of the control-target components and the non-control-target component to generate the combined result.

2. The sound field control device according to claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of control-target component extractors is configured to extract the corresponding control-target component using a control-target component extractor single-frequency adaptive notch (SAN) filter.

3. A filter determination system for setting the coefficients of the SAN filters of each of the plurality of sound controllers of the sound field control device according to claim 1, the filter determination system comprising: at least one microphone used to pick up sounds generated by the plurality of speakers, at a plurality of positions in the sound field; and a filter determination device comprising a processor configured to determine, for each of the frequencies of the control-target components, the coefficients of each of the SAN filters of the sound controller corresponding to the frequency based on a result of picking up the sounds by the at least one microphone so as to maximize a value obtained by dividing a value of sound energy in the listening area by a value of sound energy in the quiet area.

4. The filter determination system according to claim 3, wherein the filter determination device is further configured to generate a table that associates the frequencies of the control-target components with the coefficients of the SAN filters.

5. A sound field control device for producing a listening area and a quiet area in a sound field using a plurality of speakers, the sound field control device configured with a processor configured to function as: a non-control-target component extractor configured to extract a non-control-target component from a sound source signal; a speaker selector configured to select at least one of the plurality of speakers as a speaker to output the non-control-target component, based on a location of the listening area; at least one control-target component extractor each configured to extract a control-target component from the sound source signal; at least one sound controller provided respectively to the at least one control-target component extractor and configured to, for each of the plurality of speakers, adjust an amplitude and a phase of the control-target component extracted by the corresponding control-target component extractor, based on locations of the listening area and the quiet area using a filter having coefficients set for the speaker; and a plurality of sound combiners provided respectively for the plurality of speakers, the sound combiners each configured to combine the control-target component which has been extracted by the at least one control-target component extractor and whose amplitude and phase have been adjusted and the non-control-target component to generate a combined result and to output the combined result to the corresponding speaker, wherein each of the at least one control-target component extractor is configured to extract the control-target component using a single-frequency adaptive notch (SAN) filter.

